

Tim Hewitt

AWS CERTIFIED SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT - ASSOCIATE

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Career changer with thirteen years in high-standards, client-facing operations, now AWS certified and working in cloud infrastructure. I design, build, deploy and fund production AWS systems end to end — including one shipped to the iOS App Store — and document the architectural decisions, failure modes and cost tradeoffs behind each one. Seeking an entry-level cloud role where technical work and client-facing work meet.

CORE COMPETENCIES

TECHNICAL	AWS (VPC, ECS Fargate, Lambda, DynamoDB, ElastiCache, S3, CloudFront, API Gateway, Cognito, Bedrock, CloudWatch) · Terraform · AWS SAM · GitHub Actions & OIDC · Docker · Python · JavaScript / Node.js · SQL
PRACTICE	Architecture decision records · Cloud cost analysis and optimisation · Technical documentation · Stakeholder management · Team mentorship · Cross-cultural communication

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate

2026

CLOUD ARCHITECTURE PORTFOLIO · [TIMTIMTIM87.GITHUB.IO](https://timtimtim87.github.io)

Beige — Chess Tactics Trainer (iOS, shipped)

Cognito, Lightsail, Lambda, DynamoDB, Terraform

- **Shipped to the iOS App Store.** Designed a two-plane architecture separating an anonymous, latency-critical read plane (Lightsail container serving a 2.95M-puzzle SQLite catalog) from a spiky per-user write plane (API Gateway with a Cognito JWT authorizer, six Lambdas, DynamoDB).
- Built the data pipeline: re-tagged the full Lichess puzzle dataset by replaying each solution with python-chess to derive motifs, pawn structure and game phase, rather than trusting crowd-sourced tags.
- Chose Lightsail over Fargate + ALB after costing both, cutting always-on spend from roughly \$40/month to ~\$10/month with no loss of function.
- Built CI/CD on GitHub OIDC (no long-lived AWS keys), five required PR checks, and auto-deploy with a live post-deploy smoke test.
- **Diagnosed a production stale-deploy incident** that silently returned empty results; root-caused it by comparing live and local API responses, then wrote the smoke test that now blocks the same regression.

ChessChat — Real-Time Video Chess Platform

Terraform, ECS Fargate, Redis, DynamoDB, Cognito, CloudFront

- Designed a three-tier VPC across three Availability Zones (public, private app, private data) with security groups enforcing one-directional trust from internet to ALB to Fargate to Redis.
- Architected a split-host application — CloudFront + S3 for the static auth surface, ECS Fargate behind an ALB for the authenticated gameplay runtime — across a modular Terraform structure.
- Solved real-time state synchronisation with Redis, using a background finalisation queue to persist each completed game to DynamoDB in exactly one write regardless of move count.
- Built PR-gated CI (backend, frontend and Terraform checks required on main, no admin bypass) with OIDC-authenticated deploys, plus CloudWatch alarms and eight custom application metrics.
- **Analysed a real \$212/month AWS bill** and found that VPC interface endpoints bill per Availability Zone, accounting for \$89 of it; documented the fixed-versus-variable cost split and shut the environment down on that basis.

Automated Market Screener & Trading Bot

Lambda, EventBridge, API Gateway, S3, Parameter Store, AWS SAM

- Built a serverless pipeline that screens ~1,000 stocks daily against a custom strategy and delivers ranked results on demand through a Telegram bot.
- Designed a cost-optimised architecture by matching each service to the actual workload — Lambda over EC2, S3 over RDS, Parameter Store over Secrets Manager — keeping the system at effectively \$0/month.
- Secured API credentials in Parameter Store with IAM scoped to a single parameter path, and added request-level authorisation on the bot to reject unrecognised callers.
- **Diagnosed a silent production failure** — a lapsed data subscription that let the job report success on zero records — and specified the validation and CloudWatch alarming needed to catch it.

SUDOKOO — AI-Powered Sudoku Scanner

Amazon Bedrock, Lambda, API Gateway, CloudFront, S3

- Built a serverless web app that photographs a printed Sudoku puzzle and turns it into a playable game, using Amazon Bedrock (Claude) for grid extraction.
- Designed the architecture end to end: CloudFront + S3 with Origin Access Control for private static hosting, API Gateway and Lambda for the scan pipeline, and a backtracking solver for validation.
- Measured a ~50% extraction success rate from CloudWatch log analysis, categorised the two failure modes, and identified the concrete security and reliability work a production version would need.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Coach & Staff Mentor

2021 - Present

5th Element Wellness, Melbourne

- Translate complex health and fitness data into actionable business strategies and personalised client progress plans.
- Mentor and educate the coaching team to maintain consistent, high-quality service delivery.
- Analyse membership datasets to optimise class scheduling and refine targeted advertising spend.

Bosun / Deck Crew

2006 - 2019

Superyacht industry, international

- Thirteen years in a service environment where the client is on board: high expectations, no margin for error, and problems resolved in person and immediately.
- Led deck crews in complex, high-pressure maritime operations where safety and operational precision were paramount.
- Built strong cross-cultural communication skills working with international crews and guests.

EDUCATION

Guilford Young College, Tasmania